

CHAPTER ONE

EDUCATIONAL PSYCHOLOGY

Behavioural Objectives: At the end of this unit, the students should be able to:

- Define;
 - a) Psychology
 - b) Education
 - c) Educational Psychology
- Describe the scope of Educational Psychology
- Justify the introduction of educational psychology in the programme of teacher education in the Nigerian University system.
- Explain how the knowledge of educational psychology can promote teachers' efficiency in the educational system.

Introduction

Generally, psychology is defined as the science that studies behaviour and mental processes. We have also perused the numerous definitions of psychology from William James (1990) to Kenneth Clark and George Miller (1970). Two concepts: mental processes and behavior are found to be central in the above definitions of psychology. Mental processes include the impulses, urges or conditions which impel an individual to act in a certain way while behavior involves the overt, observable and measurable responses of an individual or organism to the impulses: internal and environmental.

The term education is derived from its root word, educare meaning to lead out. When considered in this manner, it means education helps to stimulate some latent faculties in the individual. This definition is rooted in Plato's theory of the Transmigration of Souls who believed that the level of intellectual attainment one is capable to reach in an earlier life is capable of influencing the acquisition of knowledge in a later life. Thus he taught that knowledge was latent and that the role of the teacher is to help stimulate that knowledge in the present life. Following this, education, therefore, has been defined as the total process of human learning by which knowledge is imparted, faculties trained and skills developed. (NPE 1977,'81). Educational psychology is therefore regarded as the application of all the principles of psychology in solving educational problems. Thus it has been variously defined as:

Ausubel defined Educational psychology as that branch of psychology that is concerned with the nature, conditions and outcomes of evaluation of school learning and retention. This definition emphasizes the school programme, what is to be learnt, the conditions which includes how the learning should take place, when, where and the result of the learning process.

Blair, Jones and Simpson defined it as a process of making judgments and taking decisions through the understanding of the learner and the process of learning. An understanding of the learner's developmental age, needs, aspirations, interests and emotional dispositions is necessary to facilitate the selection of materials and the planning of instruction.

Durojaiye described it as a way in which the learner is brought into successful interaction with the material, the teacher and the environment. For learning to occur, the teacher must be prepared, the material suitable to the student's developmental age and relevant to their needs, and the environment conducive. This can be represented as follows:

Durojaiye's Model of Educational Psychology

These definitions show that educational psychology is clearly concerned

with three major areas. These three areas can be subsumed under the major heading:

The learner in the learning environment: It identifies some characteristics of the learner; his intellectual abilities/capacity; his attitudinal dispositions, which include the emotion; developmental characteristics such as age and cognitive developmental processes, sex of the child and his entire attitude to school.

In the learning process certain characteristics have been identified such as the content learnt or presented; the nature of cognitive processes and cognitive development of the child and the difficulty of the material itself.

Evaluation of learning outcome includes the assessment of what has been presented in the class. Currently, continuous and terminal assessments are modes of evaluation. Other modes include the formative and summative evaluation.

Purpose of Educational Psychology

1. In the National Policy on Education programme, Educational Psychology aims at understanding the learning process of the Nigerian child vis-a vis his counterpart in the developed world. A number of theories have been propounded about the learning processes of an individual in Europe and America e.g. Bruner, Piaget, Maslow, etc
2. It presents modes of evaluation for learning programmers. In this wise, copies of tests are developed to measure achievement, capability, interest, aptitudes and attitudes in order to adequately identify (position or rank) the individual within the learning environment.
3. Educational psychology is used in influencing change in the curriculum of the school program, principles of curriculum development are based on principles of teaching and learning which are directly derived from the theories and commentaries in

educational psychology. It is the objective of educational psychology, therefore to orientate the teacher towards meaningful curriculum development.

4. It intends to facilitate the selection of suitable materials for learning purposes. Issues such as the difficulty level of the material, the relevance of the material, content of material are based on studies conducted by educational psychologists. Their findings direct the selection and production of learning materials for educational purposes.
5. It intends to facilitate the individual in his development towards self-actualization. Hence it is believed that the individual needs educational guidance in order to perform optimally. The principles of learning and teaching derived from educational psychology are regarded as the bedrock for the guidance towards becoming oneself.
6. It also aims at increasing class interaction within an educational programme. It studies the sociometry in class and gives directives on the nature of classroom interaction among students between teacher and pupils and between teacher and the authorities. Educational psychology aims at increasing learning conditions, outcomes and interactions between educational set-ups.

Need for Educational Psychology in the Education of the Teacher

1. Educational psychology is important in that the perception of teachers for educational programmes requires training in the principles of psychology and measurement. It is necessary for the following reasons:
2. For the understanding of the underlying factors in the learning process. Prospective teachers should be able to identify factors which facilitate or militate against the learning process.
3. The teacher will be able to analyse effectively the different cultural

backgrounds of the children. A classroom comprises children from not only different cultural backgrounds but also economic backgrounds. It is therefore also necessary for the teacher to analyse the influencing factors of these varying cultural backgrounds.

4. To understand the motives and needs of the children in the class so as to direct the children accordingly in their aspirations and academic problems. Teaching the children as a group might have some effect on the outcomes of learning. A thorough understanding of educational psychology will allow the teacher to have an adequate knowledge and analysis of the motivational disposition of the children.
5. It will allow the prospective teacher to select appropriate criterion for learning purposes. This will facilitate the preparation, production and presentation of materials at the level of the child's capability.
6. Will also allow the teacher to plan remedial work for the students. Its knowledge will teacher to analyse the limitations of the student and also plan or restructure the program wherever it is necessary.
7. It is also necessary in the training of teachers so that prospective teachers can acquire skills that are necessary in improving learning processes.
8. For the development of proper attitude and disposition towards educational programs and in particular towards teaching. Edpsy will facilitate this development in educational setting.
9. To prepare the teacher with the skill in identifying learning disabilities. One of the major problems in the classroom is the difficulty in mastering the subject content, Edpsy with its basic principles will allow the prospective teacher to plan instructional programme adequately and implement it effectively.
10. For the intelligent reading of educational literature.
11. For self-actualization and as a prospective teacher it is

necessary to have vivid training and skills in the arts and science of teaching.

The Application of Educational Psychology in the Classroom

1. To generate interest in learning programmes. If a teacher understands the basic principles of learning and what it takes to learn a material the teacher can conveniently generate interest in the classroom by the use of basic strategies in Educational Psychology
2. To inspire commitment within the school setting. The aspect of evaluation, testing and measurement can be used to commit the student to proper learning process.
3. Motivating learning between the class. An idea of reward, punishment, reinforcement and motivational theories will be handy for the teacher in motivating learning within the classroom.
4. In generating realistic aspiration among the students. By understanding the intellectual dispositions, edpsy can be used in orientating the students towards appropriate and realistic goals in life.
5. To know what is important for the learner and at what level.
6. To paste instructions in the classroom. The knowledge of schedules of reinforcement, the nature of content as well as work habit can be used to help individual in the class room in their learning processes.
7. Organizing the subject matter either in units, themes or topically.
8. In showing the inter-relatedness of the subject matter from different disciplines in educational programme.
9. In simplification of learning based on the knowledge of the cognitive processes of the child's learning theories based on the child's age and his reasoning ability, interaction of the issues

foster change and simplify learning.

10. To facilitate the asking of critical question in the classroom. It will be necessary to acquire the skill in inductive and deductive thinking; question and reasoning. These areas of Educational psychology are helpful in conducting classroom programmes.
11. In measuring and evaluating learning outcomes. A basic knowledge of measurement especially teacher made test, use of inventories, interviews, observations and humiliation records would be necessary in the assessment and evaluation of the individuals intellectual capacity and motivational disposition.
12. For educational consultation in educational programmes problems of learning, discipline interaction and phonia of the classroom can b subsumed in psychological and educational guidance problems. It can thus be used in circumventing or diagnosing early factors that can affect learning within the classroom.

Revision Questions:

1. Define:
 - a) Psychology
 - b) Education
 - c) Educational Psychology
2. Describe the scope of Educational Psychology
3. Justify the introduction of educational psychology in the programme of teacher education in the Nigerian University system
4. Explain how the knowledge of educational psychology can promote teachers' efficiency in the educational system

CHAPTER TWO

GROWTH, MATURATION AND DEVELOPMENT

GROWTH

Growth may be described as an increase in size in many parts of the body simultaneously. Growth is the increase in size that usually accompanies age increase, for example, height and weight. The human body grows by adding more centimeters in height and more grams in weight.

Oladele(1987) says that growth is a permanent increase in size of cell or protoplasm acquired by an organism in the course of its development. Growth as a process is irreversible; it is quantitative in nature and a biological process which cannot be reversed. As the organism feeds, the body processes and utilizes the consumed materials to replace worn out tissues and cells and develop or produce new ones. This type of activity brings about a change or increase in the general appearance of the organism both in size, weight and height.

Principles of Growth:

1. Growth for each individual may be fast or slow, because each individual grows at his own pace.
2. Heredity and environment are instrumental to growth.
3. Growth is a process of integration.

4. Growth involves both integration and differentiation.
5. Growth is more rapid in early age.
6. Growth depends on Maturation.

Maturation and Development:

Maturation is the act or time of becoming mature. It has to do with changes and readiness to perform a function Emenogu (1996) says maturation is the ripening of a person's inherited potentiality that is not determined by experience.

Maturation is the changes that take place in your body and in your behaviour because you are getting older, because of your age. You start to walk from crawling because you are at an age where you are physically mature to walk. A one month old baby is incapable of learning to walk simply because he/she is not mature enough to walk. All humans are biologically programmed to mature at the same rate that is to go through changes at the same or roughly the same time. Maturation cannot be influenced by the environment or learning.

Development on the other hand can be divided into two dimensions, the Phylogenetic and the Ontogenetic dimension.

1. The Phylogenetic dimensions come naturally to the person as a result of the specie they belong to, e.g. The functions are potentially present in the race they belong to, and are usually immune to learning, exercise or environmental conditions. E.g. The readiness for a child to sit, crawl, walk etc.
2. The Ontogenic functions on the other hand are traits which are peculiar to the individual. They depend on proper environmental support and stimulation. Ontogenetic functions are products of development. E.g. Swimming, Playing foot ball, Reading, Writing etc.

Differences between Growth and Development

1. Development is more comprehensive and subsumes growth.
2. Development is a continuous process, but growth terminates at a certain stage in life.
3. Growth is indicated in the body dimension e.g. weight, height, while development is expressed both in body and function.
4. Growth is quantitative, while development is qualitative.
5. Growth is influenced by intrinsic factors, while development is influenced by extrinsic factors.
6. Growth is not affected by learning, while learning and maturation are essential for development.

Implications of Development and Maturation

There are many educational implications of development and maturation.

1. Teachers need to understand what stage of cognitive development their students are, so that they can prepare lessons and methods to suit that age.
2. Teachers get to understand that mastery occurs at different paces for different learners in the classroom.
3. Learning depends on the maturation, so lessons should be planned on the maturation of the child and not on the size, so any lesson above the maturation level of the child is useless.
4. Teachers are aware that children cannot be forced to learn as maturation follows a distinct process.
5. Children's development is common, e.g. all children sit before they can crawl, so group work should be encouraged.
6. The environment is very essential to development, so teachers

should be able to create a friendly environment in order to stimulate development.

Conclusion:

1. What is: Growth, Development and Maturation?.
2. What are the implications of development and Maturation to learning?

CHAPTER THREE

LEARNING

Behavioural Objectives:

At the end of this unit, students should be able to:

1. Define the term learning
2. List and explain the principles of learning
3. List and explain the types of learning
4. Explain the theories of learning; Classical and Operant conditioning, and Insightful learning.
5. Explain the classroom implications of the theories.

Definition of learning:

Learning can be defined as a process that leads to a relative permanent change in behaviour arising from experience or practice by which one acquires attitudes, habits and abilities. The change in behaviour must necessarily improve the individual positively. For instance, when a student is taught how to solve some problems in a course and through constant practice does it better, and then learning has taken place. The improved performance is based on the practice by the student. Behaviours and thoughts which are acquired and immediately forgotten have not really been learnt. Temporary changes due to fatigue, illness, or drugs do not qualify as learned responses.

Principles of learning

The principles of learning refer to the essential guides which everyone

who desires success must take cognizance of. They are;

1. Readiness and individual differences: This implies that students should be willing to receive learning materials they are to learn. Besides, their individual uniqueness and differences must be taken into consideration in planning their curriculum and lesson note.
2. Learning from simple to the complex, old to the new: Learning is made more meaningful and easy when it starts from simple to complex and old/previous to the new.
3. Learning should be well-spaced and distributed not compassed or massed: Learning should be spaced in order to facilitate retention and understanding. Students who “wait” or “save” their learning until the “last moment” resort to mass learning which tends to be forgotten as soon as it is used in the examination.
4. Learning should appeal to students’ interest: Learning material and topics should be tailored to suit the age, capacities and experiences of the students.
5. Learning should be by active participation: Learning becomes easier when students participate actively in the learning process.
6. Motivation to learn: Students learn better when they are motivated through incentives, rewards, prize and scholarship.
7. Learning should be tailored to suit students of all kinds of abilities: In planning and designing the curriculum, provision should be made for the different kinds of learners of students. Such as; normal, gifted and slow learners.

Types of learning

Bloom (1965), in his taxonomy of educational objective, classified learning into three major parts. They are:

1. Affective learning: This deals with the acquisition of a subject matter that is not clearly visible to the human senses but is more of abstract; such as interest, attitude, feelings, values appreciation

etc.

2. Psychomotor learning: This deals with the acquisition of skills or knowledge that enables the student to use his hands and legs effectively in exhibiting a degree of knowledge. It involves neuromuscular coordination or body movement such as learning to dance, walk swim, play football etc. It is often referred to as motor skills, psychomotor skills or performance skills. It cut across different occupations.
3. Cognitive learning: This involves the learning and recall of specific and universal fact (knowledge of terminology, symbols, etc), the ability to understand and use oral or written communication (comprehension), the ability to use a theory to solve problems (application), the ability to classified material into their essential parts (analysis), the ability to put facts or materials together to constitute a new whole (synthesis) and ability to make judgments on the value of ideas and materials (evaluation).

Theories of learning

A theory can be defined as a scientific principle that forms the foundation of a particular practice. Within the context of this unit we shall discuss the following theories of learning:

1. Classical conditioning by Ivan Petrovich Pavlov.
2. Operant conditioning by Burrhus Frederick Skinner.
3. Insightful learning by Wolfgang Kohler.

Classical Conditioning Theory

(Ivan Petrovich Pavlov-1849-1936)

This theory gives attention to the learning of psychological or emotional responses like fear and anxiety. It deals with automatic conditioning of involuntary responses.

-Pavlov illustrated this as he worked on the digestive processes of his dogs. He observed that his dogs salivated at the appearance of their caretaker who came to feed. He wondered why the dogs salivated since they were unlikely to eat their caretaker. He speculated that the dogs had associated the caretaker (an initially neutral stimulus) with food (a non-neutral stimulus) that ordinarily makes dogs to salivate (an unlearned or “reflexive” response to food).

-In the language of classical conditioning, food is an unconditioned stimulus (UCS), and salivation is an unconditioned response (UCR) to food.

-He then experimented by introducing the bell (a neutral stimulus), the neutral stimulus (bell) was sounded just before the dogs were fed. After a long period of this practice of ringing the bell and serving the dogs food immediately, Pavlov then sounded the bell but withheld serving the dogs food. He observed that the dogs still salivated to the sound of the bell alone. He called this conditioned response (CR), the salivation of the dogs to an initial neutral stimulus and the sound of the bell the dogs responded to as the conditioned stimulus (CS).

- A similar approach was employed by Watson and Raynor (1920) on a nine months old boy, “Albert” to elicit the response of fear in him as he attempted to reach out to the white rat that was a friendly playmate until the introduction of the sound of a banging steel rod in his effort to reach out to the rat.

Common terms in classical conditioning are:

- Unconditioned stimulus (UCS)- A stimulus that evoke an unlearned emotion, e.g food.
- Unconditioned response (UCR)- An unlearned response to an unlearned stimulus, e.g salivation at the sight of food.

- Conditioned stimulus (CS)- A stimulus that evoke an emotional response after conditioning, e.g the sound of the bell
- Conditioned response (CR)-learned response to a previously neutral stimulus, eg salivation to the sound of the bell.

Features of classical conditioning

1. Stimulus generalization
2. Stimulus discrimination
3. Stimulus extinction

Classroom implications of classical conditioning

1. Our emotional reactions to situations are partly learnt through classical conditioning
2. Emotional learning can sometimes interfere with academic learning
3. One's past experiences can influence the present behaviour
4. Classroom serves as the designated place where emotions, ideas, facts and attitudes are learned

Operant Conditioning Theory (B. F. Skinner 1904-1990)

Operant conditioning theory also known as instrumental conditioning was propounded by an American psychologist, B. F. Skinner. He illustrated this theory of learning with a rat in cage called the "magic box". He placed a hungry rat in the cage that has lumps of food

somewhere with a connecting steel bar that can open the place where the lumps of food were located. In this experiment, the rat engaged in a spontaneous operant behaviour in the cage. It eventually pressed the steel bar connected to where the lumps of food were kept and a pellet of food dropped into the feeding cup beneath the bar. The rat ate the food and continued the random movement until it pressed the bar causing another pellet of food to drop. After several of such occurrences the rat formed an association between the act of pressing the bar and the appearance of food. The rat started pressing the bar as fast as it could in order to get pellet of food to eat. Simply put, the rat operated on the environment (cage) by pressing the bar and had a rewarding result of food being provided.

Skinner sees learning as series of experiences that influence behaviour in a similar manner conditioned responses are acquired.

In operant conditioning, the learner operates on the environment and then associates the action with the pleasant or unpleasant consequences it produces.

In operant conditioning, we talk of positive or negative reinforce. Reinforcer is any consequence that strengthens a response by making it more likely to occur in the future.

Positive reinforce is an event when introduced following a behaviour make that behaviour more probable to occur in the future. While a negative reinforce also strengthens behaviour, but the behaviour is strengthened because something unpleasant is removed from the situation (or avoided) after the behaviour occurs.

Negative reinforcement does not imply punishment. All reinforcements (positive or negative) strengthen behaviour.

Two types of punishment; positive and negative. Positive punishment occurs when an unpleasant consequence is added to the situation following a behaviour. For example, scolding a child because of rough domestic play. While negative punishment occurs when something pleasant is removed from a situation following a behaviour. For instance,

refusing a child to watch the favourite television show because of his rough domestic play.

Classroom implications of Operant conditioning

1. Constant practice strengthens the bond between stimulus and response.
2. Learning should be made to meet the learner's need.
3. Teaching aid and learning materials should be made available to facilitate learning.
4. Learning materials should be arranged from the simplest to the most difficult ones.
5. Learning occurs when new skills or behaviours are reinforced.

Insightful learning theory

This is part of field theory (Gestalt). It is also known as perceptual process of learning. It was formulated as a reaction to the stimulus-response theories that were presumed to have reduced learning to stimulus and response. The major emphasis is on the mental process by which new and revealing combinations of data are perceived.

Kohler Wolfgang (1887-1967) Experiment

Kohler illustrated insightful learning by putting an ape in a cage and put a banana outside the reach of the ape, but within the cage. He then placed

a stick within the cage, hoping that the ape would probably use the stick to draw the banana within its reach. Kohler claimed that the ape solved the problem, not by random and undirected activities, but through surveying the entire environment and realizing the presence of the stick that would help to rake the banana down. Kohler called this type of learning “insight” which is characterized by cognitive organization, restructuring of a sudden perception which comes at a flash.

-In insightful learning, the concept of configuration is partially dependent upon the phenomenon of figure –ground. The total environment needs to be perceived and be considered together. This theory emphasizes that the learner and all the circumstances that influence learning need to be considered in insightful or gestalt theory.

Classroom implications of insightful learning

1. The teacher should consider himself as part of the learning environment and create a conducive climate to promote learning.
2. Knowledge should be graded in hierarchical manner to enable students to obtain some partial glimpse (insight) of the problem before they mature to figure out the total solution.
3. The concept of figure-ground indicates that the whole and the details within the whole should be considered within the learning environment.

Questions for discussion

1. What do you understand by the term learning?
2. List and explain in detail 5 principles of learning.

3. List and explain the three types of learning you were taught.
4. Discuss either classical or instrumental conditioning theory.
5. Explain the classroom implications of classical and insightful theories of learning.
6. Distinguish between reinforcement and punishment.

CHAPTER FOUR

REMEMBERING AND FORGETTING

- Meaning
- Stages in the Learning Process
- Factors affecting learning
- Methods of measuring Retention
- Ways of improving Learning
- Retention and Recall
- Implications of remembering and forgetting in learning process.

Educational Psychologists are concerned about how information is initially placed in the memory, stored and recalled for use. The mental activities in the acquisition, processing and use of information are collectively referred to as Cognition. This process is important to teachers as it will enable teachers adopt teaching methods that will help the students remember what they have been taught.

What is Memory?

Memory is the retention of information over time, Memory can also be defined as a perceptually active mental system that receives, encodes, modifies and retrieves information. It is the process of storing and

retrieving information in the brain. The process of memory cannot be observed directly, but can be studied indirectly by way of measuring retention. When we say an individual's memory we mean his ability to recall past events. Some people have better memory than others. Memory involves encoding, storage and retrieval.

- Encoding - involves getting information into memory. Paying attention involves concentration and mental focusing. Selectivity is a critical skill in paying attention. This is the ability to focus on relevant information without being distracted. Teachers can help students to pay attention by encouraging them to do so and minimizing distractions. The learning can also be active by introducing excursions, media, technology and field trips.
- Rehearsal - This is a conscious repetition of activity over a period of time in order to increase the length of time it stays in the brain. This is good if the information is meant to stay for a short time.
- Deep Processing – This method is better than rehearsal in the sense that this method promotes longer retention of information in the memory. Information is processed semantically in terms of its meaning. People remember better when information is processed at a deeper level.
- Elaboration- This is an extension of information processing, when students are able to generate personal examples of a concept, it means elaboration has taken place. For example you are teaching the students about pollution, and then the students are able to relate it with present happenings in the environment.
- Constructing Images – In constructing images, elaboration is involved. When a student is asked to recall an event or a place, the student constructs a mental picture of the event and then takes a mental walk around the place in order to give an accurate answer.
- Organisation – It is always good to organize information as they come, when information is organized memory benefits. Information organized in a meaningful way is easier to remember,

for example, Phone numbers.

- Storage – This is the retention of information. After Information has been encoded it has to be retained. Information is stored in three prominent aspects of memory: -
- Sensory registers - From the name it is easy to deduce that this has to do with the five senses. Sight, sound, touch, taste and smell. The sensory input from here is short depends on the gravity. Most of the information that enters our senses is lost, because we do not attend to all the senses at same time.
- Short Term Memory - which is sometimes called the Working memory – This is a limited capacity system, where information is stored for a very short time, it cannot hold more than 5-9 units of information at a time, if new information is added the old one it displaces the old one. It is referred to as working memory because it involves active processing of information.
- Long-Term Memory – This is referred to as a permanent retention of information. This memory holds large amounts of information for a long period of time in a relatively permanent way. It is the memory system that allows us to remember what happened to us many years ago. When we pay attention to something and we rehearse and practice the thing it stores in our long term memory. Any information stored in the short term memory can be transferred to the long term memory through rehearsals and practice.

Remembering / Retrieval – Retrieval means taking information out of storage. When we retrieve information from our mental data bank we search through our memory store to find the relevant information. Some retrieval can be automatic, while some are difficult.

Methods of Measuring Retention

There are three basic methods of measuring retention; they are Recall,

Recognition and Learning.

1. Recall – This is also called retrieval in psychology, it is the spontaneous, unaided remembering of something learned earlier such as a song or an event. It requires the individual to retrieve information unaided. It is the most difficult method of retrieving information, this type of recall is what is needed in fill in the blank questions. (A measure of memory based on the ability to retrieve information from long term memory with few cues.)
2. Recognition – It has to do with the individual identifying previous stimuli as familiar, it requires the individual to choose the right answer from options, just like the multiple choice questions. (A measure of memory based on the ability to select correct information from among options provided.)
3. Relearning – This is the method of learning a material the second time. It takes less time to re-learn a material. (A measure of memory based on the length of time it takes to relearn forgotten materials.)

Learning and memory are very closely related, learning is the acquisition of new behaviours through experience, while Memory is the process of storing information in order to be retrieved when needed.

Factors affecting Learning:

1. Intelligence – People with high Intelligence Quotient (IQ) are better at learning. Some remember more visual things, while others remember for auditory things.
2. Environmental Factors - Noise and worry can affect concentration and learning.
3. Method of Learning – The way an individual learns could affect his memory and consequently retrieval of information.

4. Value/Significance of Learning – Individuals remember best the things that are important to them or have great significance. First impressions usually last for a long time.
5. Teacher's personality- An individual's personality is a composite of his physical appearance, his mental capacity, his emotional behaviour and his attitudes towards others. Effective teaching and learning are the results of an integrated personality of the teacher
6. Efforts to learn-Learner must show interest to learn. Students must be inspired by strong motives and a clear realization that learning has a worthwhile purpose either now or in the future.
7. Meaningfulness of learned Materials – Learners learn more when they understand and see meaning in the material learnt.
8. Physical Factors –Include such factors as health, physical development, visual and physical defect.
9. Individual differences- Since individuals differ in their ability to retain learned materials over a period , the teaching methods ought to be different to meet the needs of everybody in the learning situation.

Forgetting:

This is the inability to remember or recall information from storage. There are some theories of forgetting, these theories help to explain why people forget, and they are:

- Theory of Interference – The Cue dependent Forgetting; this is a retrieval failure due to a lack of effective retrieval cues. This explains why an individual fails to remember an answer in an exam hall even though he is sure that he knows the answer. This theory states that we forget not because we have lost the information, but because other things get in the way of what we are trying to

remember. For example, if a student takes a History test and then immediately after takes a Biology test, the History may interfere with the student's memory. A good strategy is to study last the exam that you will take first.

- Decay/Fading Theory - It is the breakdown of information, unless it is preserved through practice and reiteration. Information that is not frequently brought to the mind gradually fades. (The theory that forgetting occurs as the memory trace fade over time.)
- Displacement Theory – This states that information is easily displaced by new information, especially in the short term memory.
- Poor Retrieval Theory – This states that when an information is forgotten it does not mean that it is lost, but with the right cues it can be retrieved.
- Interference theory - This states that forgetting occurs because similar memories interfere with the storage or retrieved of information. Interference can occur from memories that were formed by prior learning (proactive interference) or from memories that were formed by later learning (retroactive interference).
- Repression – Sigmund Freud's theory states that forgetting occurs because the conscious mind often deals with unpleasant information by pushing it into unconsciousness. (Individuals tend to push from memory events that are usually associated with pain or anxiety. This however does not go but remains in the subconscious of the individual and invariably could affect the life style of the person)
- Theory of motivated forgetting - which suggests that we forget information that is unpleasant or threatening .Forgetting that is believed to be based on the upsetting or threatening nature of the information that is forgotten

Strategies for Enhancing Memory:

One of the duties of a teacher is to enhance the memory of the students to enable them achieve academic excellence. This can be done in the following ways.

1. Encourage students to understand the lesson rather than cram it. Rote learning is bad.
2. Students should be taught how to organize what they put in their memory.
3. Students should be encouraged to ask themselves questions on what they have learnt.
4. Students should be taught how to use Mnemonics when learning, they involve imagery and words. For example , MR. Niger

Implications for Learning:

Remembering and Forgetting are very important to learning because they hold the key to retention and the loss of information. Forgetting is a loss of information. Failure to retrieve an information could just simply mean that the information was not properly coded. The more similar two items are the more likely for there to be interference during encoding, to reduce this from happening there is a need to show meaningfulness when teaching; also there is a need to arrange information or materials in a sequential way.

Steps to help Students Remember and Minimize Forgetting

- Organize teaching activities in such a way that it reflects student's readiness to learn.
- Use adequate educational techniques.
- Use repetition in order to aid understanding.
- Associate new learning with old learning.
- Encourage active participation of students in the classroom.

- Teaching concepts should be as practical as possible.
- Teachers should capitalize on student's interest, the more interested they are, the more they will be willing to learn.

Revision Questions

1. What is memory?
2. What is remembering?
3. What do you understand by forgetting?
4. Discuss two theories of forgetting.
5. Discuss ways of improving retention and recall.

CHAPTER FIVE

TRANSFER OF LEARNING

Learning Objective:

- Define transfer of learning and to gain an appreciation of the importance of transfer of learning in human life.
- Understand the Factors that can enhance Transfer of learning.
- Have an understanding of the different types of Transfer of Learning.
- Have an understanding of the importance of teaching for transfer of learning.

Introduction

The number one purpose of any learning or education is that its recipients, who acquire these knowledge or skill in a formal and controlled situation like a classroom, or a training situation, will be able to transfer such knowledge and skill to real life situations and adapt more effectively and the contrary the aforementioned does not happen, then any or all the exercise in learning or any system of education is an utter waste because no individual is going to spend his entire lifetime in the laboratory or a classroom or a training institute to learn on each

occasion to solve his or her problems. Thus, the purpose of any teaching-learning interaction is to bring about a generalisation and application of what has been learnt in specific diverse situations to real life situations.

Learners store information learnt, or basic units of knowledge in their long-term memory, while the arrival of new information enters the working memory, the long-term memory is searched for associations which combine with the new information in working memory. These associations then reinforce the new information and help assign meaning to it. Meaning that learning in one situation can facilitate learning in another area i.e. Learning that takes place in varying contexts can create more links and encourage generalization of the skill or knowledge. Thus the connections between past learning and new learning can provide a foundation or framework for the new information, helping students to determine sense and meaning, and encouraging retention of the new information.

Definitions and Meaning of Transfer of Learning

The word transfer of learning is used to describe the effects of past learning upon present acquisition or learning. In simple words transfer of learning may be defined as “the partial or total application or carryover of knowledge, skills, habits, attitudes from one situation to another situation” as how well and how rapidly we learn anything depends to a large extent upon the kinds and amount of things we have learned previously. According to Baldwin and Ford, (2006) Transfer of learning or transfer of knowledge refers to learning in one context and applying it to another, i.e. the capacity to apply acquired knowledge and skills to new situations. Darling-Hammond and Bransford (2005) define transfer of learning as the ability to apply previous learning to a new situation, problem, or to future learning. Another definition explains it as the effect of prior learning on present learning or on the subsequent performance of different tasks (Ohanaka & Audu, 2012).

Transfer of learning occurs when people apply information, strategies, and skills they have learned to a new situation or context. Transfer of

learning is the effect that learning in one situation has on another especially when learning in one context enhances (or undermines) a related performance in another context (Igbineweka, 2020). It could also be said to be the ability to apply previous learning to a new situation, problem, or to future learning i.e. the process by which learning in one context enhances or undermines a related performance in another context.

Factors that can enhance Transfer

1. Learners can increase transfer of learning through effective and constant practice and by mindfully abstracting knowledge. When we say abstraction, it means the process of examining our experiences for similarities and this include seeking the underlying principles in what is learned, creating models, and identifying analogies and metaphors, all of which assist with creating associations and encouraging transfer.
2. Ability to perceive similarities; seeking commonalities between original learning and new one, such as environment and other memory cues.
3. Critical attributes: Transfer depends on characteristics that make something or the learning unique
4. Association: Transfer depends on extensive connections between multiple events, actions, bits of information, and so on; as well as the conditions and emotions connected to it by the learner.
5. Context and degree of original learning: how well the learner acquired the knowledge
6. Thorough and Diverse Practice: Transfer depends on extensive practice of the performance in question in a variety of context. As the saying goes "practice makes perfect".

7. Similarity between subject and activities: Transfer is attained in a second situation by the extent to which it possess factors that were present in the prior situation. The similarities of two situations may be in likeness or method or procedure, in content or in common aims.
8. Active self – monitoring: Related, metacognitive reflection on one's thinking processes appears to promote transfer of skills. Belmont, Butter filed and Ferretti (1982) undertook a synthesis of efforts to teach retarded children simple memory strategies and to test whether the children would apply these in slightly different context. Many of these studies showed no transfer, while a few revealed some. The researchers isolated the factors that appeared to account for success; teaching the children not just to apply the strategy but to monitor their own thinking processes in simple ways. Presumably, this activation of self-monitoring helped the children later to recognize when they might apply the strategy they had learned.

Types of Transfer of Learning

1. Positive Transfer: This occurs when learning in one situation facilitates learning in another situation; it is known as positive transfer. For example, skills in playing violin facilitate learning to play piano. Knowledge of mathematics facilitates to learn physics in a better way.
2. Negative Transfer: Negative transfer occurs when learning of one task makes the learning of another task harder; it is known as negative transfer. For example, speaking chines language may hinder the learning of English or when a Left hand drive vehicle hinders the learning of right hand drive.
3. Neutral transfer: This occurs when learning of one activity neither facilitates nor hinders the learning of another task; it is also called as zero transfer. For example the knowledge of Religious study in no way affects learning of driving a car or a bike.

4. Far Transfer: Far transfer occurs when the new situation is very different from that in which learning occurred.
5. Near Transfer: Near transfer occurs when many elements overlap between the conditions in which the learner obtained the knowledge or skill and the new situation. I.e. when an auto-mechanic repairs an engine in a new model car, but with a design much the same as in prior models.
6. Vertical Transfer: It occurs when learning at a lower behavioural level facilitates learning at a higher level. In mathematics, simple additions, subtraction multiplication and division learnt at a lower level could be applied in solving problem of quadratic equation at a higher level.
7. Horizontal Transfer: This form of transfer involves using ideas, knowledge or skills from one level of experience at a particular situation to the same level of experience in another similar situation. I.e. when knowledge of Physics in Senior secondary class two aid mathematical knowledge at the same level
8. Lateral Transfer: This occurs when performing the skill exactly as learned but in a new situation or context for example, the ability to use the knowledge of the concept of averages in mathematics to find the mean of a set of data in social studies.
9. Low – Road Transfer: It occurs when well-established skills transfer spontaneously, even automatically because the task has been practiced extensively in different environment similar to the expected transfer context.
10. High – Road Transfer: This type of transfer occurs when the learner consciously and deliberately ("mindfully") evaluates the new situation and applies previous learning to it.

TEACHING FOR TRANSFER OF LEARNING

- The only reason for teaching most topics in the classroom is to enable students to use what they learn in settings beyond the

school and if there is to be any improvement in the learning outcomes of students. A deliberate and conscious effort must be made both on the part of the teacher and student. The following are some effective ways to promote positive transfer.

- Teach subject matter meaningfully rather than rote context. Define the objectives of the lesson clearly while information that is not meaningful will not be associated with other information.
- Teach subject matter in context as similar as possible to those in which it will be employed. When information is learnt in settings similar to those in which it will be applied, learners can use clues from the learning situation to trigger the use of appropriate skills and information when they are later needed.
- Show relationship between what is being taught and other subject or with real life situation. What is taught should be related to circumstances within the environment.
- Provide opportunity to practice employing the subject matter in settings that represent the full range of eventual application. Revision of instructions should be carried out to make the learner master the information so as to transfer it to related tasks.
- Students should be presented with several variations of the same concept, and the common principles should be made clear. Students should master the original material thoroughly in order for transfer to take place.
- Differences between concepts and principles should be stressed. Understanding the differences between concepts and principles could help minimize negative transfer.
- The use of appropriate teaching strategies is very important. Teaching for transfer and improved learning outcomes depends most heavily on the type and appropriateness of the teaching activities or method used.

Revision Questions

1. What is transfer of learning?
2. Describe the various types of transfer you were taught
3. Explain five conditions necessary for transfer
4. What are the implications of transfer for teaching and learning?

CHAPTER SIX

MOTIVATION

Objectives:

- Meaning Of Motivation
- Types and Kinds of Motivation
- Maslow's theory of Motivation
- Strategies for motivating Learners

Meaning of Motivation

Motivation was derived from the latin word “Movere” which means to ‘move’. Motivation is the area of psychological science concerned with the factors that energize or stimulate behaviour. It focuses on what produces behaviour, for example what makes you get up in the morning and go to class? (Gazzaniga, Heatherton, Halphen, 2010). Motivation is also a want or desire that energizes and directs behaviour towards a goal. It is a psychological process that leads us to do certain things (Long, 2000). It is a psychological process of stimulating, arousing or propelling movement in living organisms.

Motivational concepts emphasize four essential qualities of motivational state. First motivational states are energizing. They activate or arouse behaviour. Second, motivational states are directive. They guide behaviours towards satisfying specific goals or specific needs. Hunger motivates eating; thirst motivates drinking. Third, motivational states help people persist in their behaviour until goals are achieved or needs satisfied. Hunger stares at you until you find something to eat; desire to

succeed drives to practice very well. Fourth, motivational states differ in strength depending on the internal or external factors.

Types of Motivation

1. **Intrinsic Motivation:** refers to the value or pleasure that is associated with an activity that has no obvious external goal, for example, playing, solving crossword puzzles or listening to music. Motivation to perform an activity because of the value or pleasure associated with that activity, rather than for an apparent external goal or purpose. It evolves from within the individual without any external motif. In other words, the incentive for engaging in behaviour or completing a task is performing the task itself. Intrinsically motivated behaviours are performed for their own sake. They simply are enjoyable.
2. **Extrinsic Motivation:** as opposed to intrinsic motivation emphasizes external goals an activity is directed towards, such as reducing or obtaining a reward, for example, working to earn a pay check. Extrinsic motivation is reward driven behaviour like rewards, incentives, praise, fame or money. Motivation to perform an activity because of the external goals towards which that activity is directed. In addition External motivation could include rewards, gifts or verbal praise usually given to the individual to perform behaviour or reinforce it.

Kinds of Motivation

- **Positive Motivation-** a technique in which a person is rewarded for attaining a goal, task or displaying/changing a particular behaviour. It involves defining factors that turns a good thought into immediate action. The rewards could be immediate or in future. For example, in the schools, students are motivated to achieve academic excellence. When attained, they are rewarded with monetary prize, promotion, scholarship, verbal praise is awarded.

- Negative Motivation- the opposite concept. The action is motivated by fear or apprehension that an undesirable outcome will emerge from not acting. Negative motivation may also occur when unpleasant or painful measures are used on the individual such as suspension, expulsion, verbal assault, demotion, sack, rustication, threats, spanking, etc.

Maslow's theory of Motivation

In the 1940's Abraham Maslow proposed an influential "Need Theory" of motivation. Maslow's theory is an example of humanistic psychology, viewing people as striving towards personal fulfillment. Maslow believed that humans are driven by many needs which he arranged into a need hierarchy below

- Physiological needs: The first of the id-driven needs on Maslow's hierarchy are physiological needs. They are basic human survival needs which include food, water, adequate rest, clothing and shelter, Health and Wellbeing, and reproduction. Maslow believed that these basic physiological needs must be met before humans move proceed to the next step
- Safety needs: Safety is the next among lower-level needs. Safety needs include protection from violence and harm, protection from threats, emotional/psychological stability and well-being, health and financial security.
- Love and belonging needs: Maslow's third hierarchy relate to human and social interaction and are the last on the lower needs. These needs are friendships and family bonds—both with biological family, extended and non-family relationships. Physical and emotional intimacies from sexual relationships to intimate emotional bonds are important in achieving a satisfying feeling. In addition, it includes membership in social groups, union, clubs, or group of hobbyists.
- Esteem needs: The higher needs, starting with esteem, are ego-driven needs. The primary elements of esteem are self-respect and

self-esteem. Maslow opined that self-esteem can be broken into two types: esteem which is based on respect and acknowledgment from others, and esteem which is based on your own self-assessment. Self-confidence and independence stem from this latter type of self-esteem.

- Self-actualization needs: Self-actualization explains the fulfillment of attaining full personal potential, dreams or aspirations. Often called self-fulfillment needs, self-actualization needs occupy the highest position on Maslow's pyramid structure. Self-actualization needs include education, skill development such as music, athletics, design, cooking, and gardening—caring for others, and broader goals like learning a new language, traveling to new places, and winning awards.

Concepts of Motivation

- Needs: a state of deficiency, which can be either biological; e.g. water or social; to be with other people. Either way, needs lead to goal directed behaviours. Failure to satisfy a particular need leads to psychosocial or physical impairment
- Incentives: are external objects or goals that motivate behaviour. Getting a good grade on the exam is an incentive for studying hard. Some things are more valuable to us than others and are highly motivated to obtain them.
- Arousal : a generic term used to describe physiological activation (such as increased brain activity), or increased automatic responses (such as sweating, muscle tension or quickened heart rate)
- Drive: are psychological states that encourage behaviours that satisfy needs.e.g Oxygen(Need)=Feeling for Suffocation(Drive)=Breathing(Behaviour)
- Food(Need)=Hunger(Drive)=Eating(Behaviour)

- Water(Need)=Thirst(Drive)=Drinking(Behaviour)
- Homeostasis: the tendency for bodily functions to maintain steadiness or equilibrium

Strategies for motivating Learners

1. Arousing interest and maintaining curiosity of students
2. Instructional presentations should be interesting thereby sustain students interest in learning. Again, variety of methods should be adopted to facilitate understanding students.
3. Promote goal oriented mindset
4. Students should be assisted to set their own goals. Students perform better when goals are set before them even though the goals were set by others
5. Clear academic outcomes
6. Students should be directed to have understanding of what they are expected to do and know, how they will be evaluated and possible rewards for success or failure.
7. Clear and specific feedback
8. Feedbacks are necessary as they serve as incentives to both teachers and students. They should be detailed, informative and rewarding. Positive Behaviours can be reinforced or while negative behaviours can be changed from this process.
9. Use of rewards
10. Use of incentives should be encouraged as they motivate students. In school, teacher's gift and praise to students can be a source of motivation.

Revision Questions

1. (a) What is motivation
(b) List and explain the types and kinds of motivation.
2. With examples, explain intrinsic and extrinsic motivation.
3. Using a diagram, list and discuss in detail Maslow's hierarchy of needs.

CHAPTER SEVEN

EXCEPTIONAL CHILDREN

Objectives:

- Meaning Of Exceptional Children
- Categories For Exceptionality
- Possible Causes For Exceptionality
- Management Strategies For Exceptional Learners

Preamble:

There are individual differences among children. This uniqueness may be in terms of their physical characteristics, emotional or social ability, learning abilities, intellect, behaviour and communication skills. However, some children are extremely different from the norm either below or above it, such that they require personalized or special education for them to benefit from Education.

The National Policy on Education (FRN, 2004), recognizes as people with special needs, adults and children who are visually impaired (blind, partially sighted), deaf, or partially deaf, physically and health impaired, mentally retarded, socially and emotionally maladjusted, learning disabled and the multi- handicapped. Also in this group are specially talented or gifted children. Therefore, there is a required modification of the curriculum and instruction for them to benefit maximally and fulfil their potentials.

Meaning of Exceptional Children

The concept of exceptionality includes these terms disability, impairment and handicap and are sometimes used interchangeably, but they are not synonymous. Impairment refers to loss of or reduced ability of a particular organ or part of the body to function e.g. loss of a limb, loss of or reduced hearing; in other words, a limitation in functioning of the organ or part. A disability exists when impairment limits a person's ability to perform certain tasks such as walking, hearing, etc. A handicap is a condition imposed on a person who has a disability. This condition could be imposed by the society, physical environment or the person's own attitude (Santrock, 2001). For example, when children who are on wheel chair are unable to access certain facilities because of the physical structure of the environment, they are handicapped by the environment.

Federal Republic of Nigeria (2004: 7) defines special education as: The education of children and adults who have learning difficulties because of different types of handicaps; blindness, partial sightedness, deafness, hardness of hearing, mental retardation, social maladjustment, limb deformity or malformation due to circumstances of birth, inheritance, social position, mental and physical health patterns or accident in later life. As a result, such children and adults are unable to cope with the regular school class organization and methods. There are also the specifically gifted and talented children who are intellectually precocious and find themselves insufficiently challenged by the programmes of the regular school

The aims of special education as stated in the policy are as follows:

(a) To give a concrete meaning to the idea of equalizing educational opportunities for all

children; their physical, mental and emotional disabilities notwithstanding;

(b) To provide adequate education for all handicapped children and adults, in order that

they may play their roles fully in contributing to the development of the nation;

(c) To provide opportunities for exceptionally gifted children to develop their skills at

their own pace, in the interest of the nation's economic and technological development.

Categories for Exceptionality

The scope of Special Education of exceptional children covers areas such as:

(a) Giftedness

(b) Mental impairment

(c) Physical impairment

(d) Emotional difficulties

(e) Visual impairments

(f) Auditory impairments

(g) Learning disabilities and

(h) Special disorders

According to Hornby (1998), the classification system in special education means one of a number of more or less formal and systematic schemes for describing children and their problems. Although so many arguments have been put forward against these

classifications,

those who argue in favour of their use assert that labels and classification can be used in the planning of intervention programmes. Classification of exceptional children is essential to get services for them, to plan and organize helping programmes and to determine the outcome of intervention efforts.

Possible Causes of Learning Disabilities

The causes of exceptionalities are not static but some scientists have postulations as to why they develop. They include:

- Genetic Influence – Experts affirmed that heredity could play a dominant role since unique characteristics run in families although this it is not conclusive.
- Environmental Influence - Environmental agents have shown to demonstrate neurotoxin effects in humans especially at their early lives. Exposure to such environmental agents can result in a spectrum of adverse outcomes from severe mental retardation and disability to more subtle changes in function. Additionally, Infants and young children are susceptible to environmental toxins (poisons) e.g. lead which is found in homes (in water pipes or paint) is sometimes thought to contribute to learning disability. Poor nutrition early in life may also contribute to learning disability later in life.

Management Strategies for Exceptional Children

1. The needs of the child must be considered first in educating exceptional children.
2. The teacher must be calm and peaceful in dealing with the learner.
3. The teacher must provide opportunities for assessing, testing

academic progress of exceptional children.

4. The curriculum and instructional plan should be modified to encourage children's dependence and success.
5. Care, Love, warm and acceptance should be expressed always by the teacher to the learners.
6. For Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD), , class work instructions and homework should be simplified and repeated supported with visual and verbal instructions.
7. For visually impaired learners, recorded textbooks, talking watch, brailled text books and other visually impaired gadgets/materials should be provided.
8. For hearing Impaired Learners, oral approach includes lip reading, speech reading and whatever hearing the student has while Manual approaches involve sign language and finger spelling.
9. For physically challenged learners, adaptive devices and medical technology that ease movement should be provided to enable the children function effectively in school.
10. For mentally retarded learners, Instruction should be individualized to meet the child's needs, concrete examples of concepts should be given and Instructions should be simple and clear. Learners' efforts should be reinforced.
11. For Gifted Learners, special classes and accelerated instruction should be introduced to accelerate their progress. In addition, instructional methods should capture their interest and stimulate curiosity to learn more.

Revision Questions

1. Who are children with special needs?
2. What are the categories of exceptional children?
3. What are the management strategies for children with special needs?

CHAPTER 8

INDIVIDUAL DIFFERENCES

Individual differences implies that no two persons are exactly the same or alike in all aspects. There is the tendency to group people together by some common traits of characteristics such as ; their places of origin,- Hausa, Yoruba, German, Edo, their occupation - Medicine, Law, Pharmacy, Carpentry, Teaching and so on. Twins and even children born by the same parents are not alike in all aspects. Differences in persons can be seen in physical forms like; height, weight, colour, strength etc. Differences also exist in intelligence, achievement, interest, attitude, aptitude, learning habits, motor abilities skills. Each man has an intellectual capability through which he gains experience and learning. Every person has the emotions of love, anger and feeling of pressure and pain. Everyman has the need of independence, success and need for acceptance.

In broad terms individual differences can be classified into two categories- Inherited traits (physical, mental and temperamental) and

Acquired traits (social, cultural, education and emotional.

TYPES OF INDIVIDUAL DIFFERENCES.

There are two main types of individual differences namely:

1. Intra -Individual differences and
2. Inter –Individual differences

Intra- individual differences refers to the differences that exist in an individual right from conception till death. Every individual in life shows remarkable variations from conception to birth from birth to adolescence and from adolescence to adulthood. An individual can be fat at one time and at another time slim. A friend can be seen as beautiful now and ugly a year after.

Inter individual differences refers to differences between two or more persons. These differences could be due to heredity and environment. Such differences could be in terms of sex, (differences between boy or girl). Emotions, abilities, skin colour are also areas of inter- individual differences.

HOW INDIVIDUAL DIFFERENCES AFFECT THE LEARNER

The teacher should:

1. Consider the age, interest and mental ability of the learner before giving any task.
2. Note the differences in the learners home background but should not be carried away by emotions and sentiments
3. Be encouraged to study independently both at home and in school.
4. Group learners for any task according to their mental ability
5. Adopt individual method of teaching in order to teach all members

of the group / class positively.

6. Vary hi/her method of teaching in order to satisfy all the types of learners in the class. – Socratic, play way, lecture methods etc could be used depending on the mental level of the learner and the topics taught.
7. Use adequate instructional materials to make the lesson more explicit and meet the individual needs of the learners. Concrete or real objects should be used when possible or improvisation done when appropriate.

CHAPTER 9

THE TEACHER

A teacher is a person who helps students to acquire knowledge, competence and skills. He provides education for pupils and students. The teacher's duty is mainly in school or other places of formal education. Teacher may use a lesson plan to facilitate student learning, providing a planned course of study which is called the curriculum.

ROLES OF THE TEACHER

The primary role of the teacher is to deliver the classroom instruction that help students to learn effectively. The teacher should prepare effective lesson, grade students work, offer feedback, manage classroom materials productively, navigate the curriculum and collaborate with other staff.

Other roles of a teacher include :

- Inspire, motivate encourage and educate learners
- Learning mediator, role model, a prompter, organizer
- loco parentis
- Interpreter and designer of learning programs and materials
- Leader, administrator and manager

- Scholar, researcher, lifelong learner and assessor.

QUALITIES OF A TEACHER

Among the qualities of a teacher are :

1. Good communication, classroom management, student –teacher collaborate skills, patience, confidence, capacity to structure and engage students with humour, creativity and lesson plans, ability to integrate, educational technology in classroom and stay updated with the changing trends in Education.
2. Show empathy and share best practices, willingness to be updated in knowledge and share knowledge and experience with others.
3. A life long learner- Building a strong foundation of knowledge and real world experience is key to becoming a good teacher.

REVISION QUESTIONS

1. Give a brief meaning of individual differences
2. List and explain the types of individual differences
3. How does individual differences affect the learner
4. List and explain 5 roles of a teacher
5. List and explain 5 qualities of a teacher